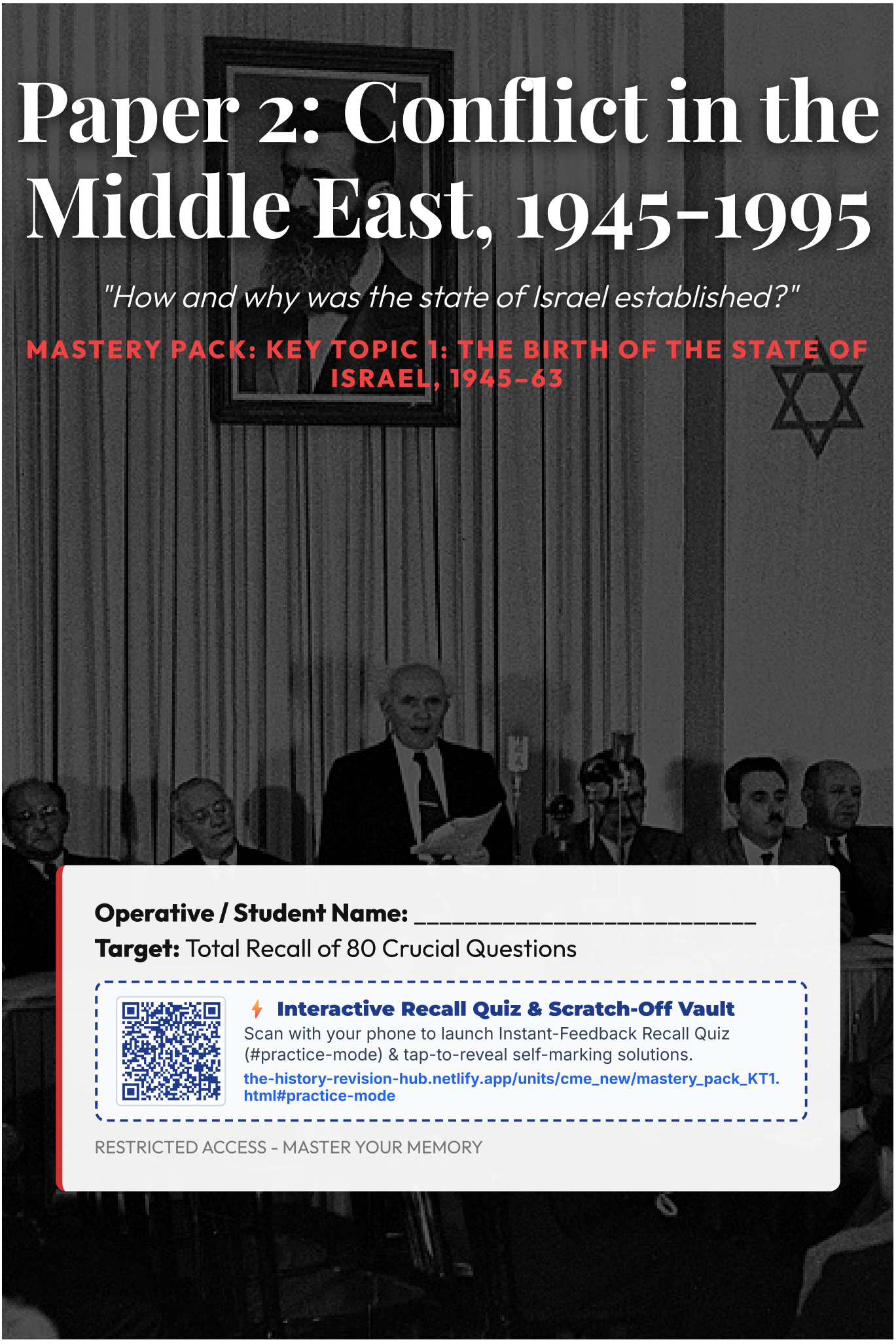


Paper 2: Conflict in the Middle East, 1945-1995

"How and why was the state of Israel established?"

MASTERY PACK: KEY TOPIC 1: THE BIRTH OF THE STATE OF ISRAEL, 1945–63

Operative / Student Name: _____

Target: Total Recall of 80 Crucial Questions

Interactive Recall Quiz & Scratch-Off Vault

Scan with your phone to launch Instant-Feedback Recall Quiz (#practice-mode) & tap-to-reveal self-marking solutions.

the-history-revision-hub.netlify.app/units/cme_new/mastery_pack_KT1.html#practice-mode

RESTRICTED ACCESS - MASTER YOUR MEMORY

How to Hack Your Memory

(Rules of Engagement)

1. Never Just Read

Reading the answers feels like learning, but it's an illusion. You must force your brain to struggle to find the answer. The struggle is what builds memory pathways.

2. Cover, Recall, Check

Cover the answer sheet. Write your answer down in the notes section (or say it out loud). Only then are you allowed to check 'The Vault'.

3. Track Your Threat Level

Use the R-A-G (Red, Amber, Green) checkboxes next to every question after you attempt it.

- 🟩 **Green:** I nailed it instantly.
- 🟨 **Amber:** I got it, but I had to think hard.
- 🟥 **Red:** My mind went blank. (Revisit these tomorrow).

4. The Interrogation (Homework Protocol)

True mastery requires testing under pressure. Hand 'The Vault' (answers) to your parent or guardian. They will test you on 20 random questions. They hold the score; they hold the signature.

5. The 3-Star Parent Effort Rubric

When authenticating your spaced retrieval practice on the final Mastery Tracker, your parent or guardian will evaluate your effort using the following criteria:

- ⭐ ⭐ ⭐ **3 Stars (Full Mastery):** Completed under strict exam conditions without glancing at notes or the Knowledge Vault. Total independent recall.
- ⭐ ⭐ **2 Stars (Consolidating):** Required 1–2 hints from the Knowledge Vault, but demonstrated sound foundational understanding.
- ⭐ **1 Star (Needs Intervention):** Rushed, mind went blank, or completed with notes open. Target facts must be hunted down and re-tested tomorrow.

KT 1.0: Broken Promises & Imperial Borders: Why Was Conflict in the Middle East Inevitable?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
1	What crucial man-made waterway connects the Mediterranean Sea to the Red Sea, serving as a vital strategic chokepoint for international trade and oil?	☐	☐	☐	
2	Which strategic maritime passage at the mouth of the Gulf of Aqaba was blockaded by Egypt in 1956 and 1967, acts that Israel considered causes of war?	☐	☐	☐	
3	Which triangular desert peninsula connecting Africa to Asia was captured by Israel from Egypt in 1956 and 1967, before being returned under the Camp David Accords?	☐	☐	☐	
4	Which strategic river forms the natural eastern boundary of the West Bank, flowing south from the Sea of Galilee into the Dead Sea?	☐	☐	☐	
5	Which ancient and holy city, claimed as a capital by both Israelis and Palestinians, was divided between 1948 and 1967 before Israeli forces captured the Old City?	☐	☐	☐	
6	Which elevated volcanic plateau bordering south-western Syria was captured by Israel during the 1967 Six Day War due to its dominant military vantage point over Galilee?	☐	☐	☐	
7	Which narrow coastal strip bordering Egypt's Sinai Peninsula came under Egyptian military control in 1948, was captured by Israel in 1967, and became an epicenter of the 1987 Intifada?	☐	☐	☐	
8	Which territory west of the River Jordan was annexed by Jordan in 1950, occupied by Israel in 1967, and became the central focus of Jewish settlement expansion?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
9	What was the de facto border established by the 1949 Armistice Agreements separating Israel from the West Bank, Gaza Strip, and Golan Heights until 1967?	☐	☐	☐	
10	Which arid southern desert region accounted for over 55% of the total land area allocated to the Jewish state under the 1947 UN Partition Plan?	☐	☐	☐	
11	Which southern Israeli port city on the Gulf of Aqaba provides Israel with maritime access to the Red Sea, East Africa, and Asia without using the Suez Canal?	☐	☐	☐	
12	Which strategic fortified coastal town at the southern tip of the Sinai Peninsula directly commands the entrance to the Straits of Tiran?	☐	☐	☐	
13	Which major freshwater lake in northern Israel, fed by the River Jordan, was a frequent source of border clashes with Syria in the 1950s and 1960s?	☐	☐	☐	
14	Which region north of Israel's border became known as 'Fatahland' in the 1970s as the PLO launched cross-border rocket attacks against northern Israeli towns?	☐	☐	☐	
15	What was the massive Israeli chain of sand-wall fortifications built along the eastern bank of the Suez Canal after 1967 to defend against an Egyptian crossing?	☐	☐	☐	
16	Which capital city was subjected to a brutal three-month siege and heavy IDF bombardment in the summer of 1982, leading to the evacuation of the PLO to Tunisia?	☐	☐	☐	
17	What was the political movement that emerged in the late 19th century advocating for the establishment of a sovereign Jewish national homeland in Palestine?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
18	What was the primary conflict between Arab and Jewish demands in Palestine as the British Mandate drew to a close in 1945?	☐	☐	☐	
19	Which neighboring Arab kingdom east of the River Jordan, ruled by King Abdullah I, annexed the West Bank and East Jerusalem following the 1948–49 War?	☐	☐	☐	
20	In 1945 at the end of the Second World War, what was the approximate demographic balance of the population living in Mandatory Palestine?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): _____

Date: _____

KT 1.1: The End of the British Mandate and the Creation of Israel, 1945–1949

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
21	What were the core conflicting demands of Palestinian Arabs and Jewish Zionists within the British Mandate immediately after 1945?	☐	☐	☐	
22	What tragic event on 22 July 1946 broke British civilian morale and accelerated their withdrawal from Palestine?	☐	☐	☐	
23	Which refugee ship carrying 4,500 Holocaust survivors was intercepted by the British Royal Navy in July 1947 and forcibly returned to displaced persons camps in Germany?	☐	☐	☐	
24	What did United Nations Resolution 181 (passed on 29 November 1947) propose for Palestine?	☐	☐	☐	
25	What was the Jewish Agency's reaction to UN Resolution 181 compared to that of the Arab Higher Committee?	☐	☐	☐	
26	What was the primary military objective of the Haganah's 'Plan Dalet' (Plan D) launched in April 1948?	☐	☐	☐	
27	What notorious event on 9 April 1948 involved an Irgun and Lehi attack on an Arab village, causing widespread panic and civilian flight?	☐	☐	☐	
28	Who read the Declaration of Independence establishing the State of Israel in Tel Aviv on 14 May 1948?	☐	☐	☐	
29	What happened on 15 May 1948, the day after Israel declared its independence?	☐	☐	☐	
30	How did the first UN-negotiated truce in June 1948 provide Israel with a decisive operational advantage?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
31	Which UN mediator was assassinated in Jerusalem in September 1948 by the radical Jewish militant group Lehi (Stern Gang)?	☐	☐	☐	
32	What was the name of the official border established by the 1949 Armistice Agreements between Israel and its Arab neighbors?	☐	☐	☐	
33	By the end of the 1948–49 Arab-Israeli War, what percentage of mandatory Palestine was controlled by Israel?	☐	☐	☐	
34	Which Arab military force proved to be the most effective and well-trained during the 1948–49 War, successfully holding the Old City of Jerusalem?	☐	☐	☐	
35	What was the 'Sergeants Affair' of July 1947, which caused widespread outrage in Britain?	☐	☐	☐	
36	What happened to the territory designated for an independent Palestinian Arab state under UN Resolution 181 following the 1948–49 war?	☐	☐	☐	
37	Why was the Israeli supply corridor to Jerusalem known as the 'Burma Road' constructed in June 1948?	☐	☐	☐	
38	What incident in June 1948 nearly sparked a civil war inside Israel when Ben-Gurion ordered the shelling of an Irgun arms ship off Tel Aviv?	☐	☐	☐	
39	Which superpower was the first to grant de jure diplomatic recognition to the State of Israel in May 1948?	☐	☐	☐	
40	Where were the formal 1949 armistice talks between Israel and Egypt, Jordan, Lebanon, and Syria held under UN auspices?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): _____

Date: _____

KT 1.2: The Aftermath of the 1948–49 War & The Palestinian Refugee Crisis

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
41	What Arabic term, meaning 'Catastrophe', is used to describe the expulsion and flight of approximately 700,000 Palestinians during the 1948–49 War?	☐	☐	☐	
42	What was the core principle established by UN General Assembly Resolution 194 in December 1948 regarding Palestinian refugees?	☐	☐	☐	
43	Which United Nations agency was established in December 1949 to provide direct relief, education, and healthcare to displaced Palestinians?	☐	☐	☐	
44	What landmark Israeli law passed in July 1950 granted every Jewish individual worldwide the right to immigrate to Israel and receive citizenship?	☐	☐	☐	
45	What legislation passed by the Israeli Knesset in 1950 allowed the state to take custody of land and properties belonging to displaced Palestinian Arabs?	☐	☐	☐	
46	What was Operation Magic Carpet (1949–1950)?	☐	☐	☐	
47	Why was the 1952 Reparations Agreement signed between Israel and West Germany so controversial inside Israel?	☐	☐	☐	
48	What term was used to describe armed Palestinian guerrilla raiders who crossed armistice lines to launch cross-border attacks against Israeli targets in the 1950s?	☐	☐	☐	
49	What was the primary goal of Israel's military 'reprisal policy' developed during the 1950s under Moshe Dayan and David Ben-Gurion?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
50	Which controversial Israeli commando raid in October 1953, led by Major Ariel Sharon and Unit 101, resulted in the dynamiting of houses and 69 civilian deaths in a West Bank village?	☐	☐	☐	
51	Why was King Abdullah I of Jordan assassinated by a Palestinian gunman outside the Al-Aqsa Mosque in Jerusalem in July 1951?	☐	☐	☐	
52	What was the significance of the Israeli raid on Gaza on 28 February 1955?	☐	☐	☐	
53	What was the 'Tzena' regime in Israel between 1949 and 1953?	☐	☐	☐	
54	Under what legal framework did Palestinian Arab citizens who remained inside the State of Israel live between 1948 and 1966?	☐	☐	☐	
55	What was the impact of the February 1955 Israeli raid on Gaza (Operation Black Arrow) that killed 38 Egyptian soldiers?	☐	☐	☐	
56	Which demographic group of Jewish immigrants faced significant discrimination, poor tent encampments (Ma'abarot), and social marginalization upon arrival in 1950s Israel?	☐	☐	☐	
57	Which Arab country formally granted full citizenship to the Palestinian refugees residing within its borders after 1949?	☐	☐	☐	
58	What regional defense treaty, organized by Britain in 1955 to contain Soviet influence, was fiercely opposed by Egypt's Gamal Abdel Nasser as Western neo-colonialism?	☐	☐	☐	
59	How did the United States support the young State of Israel economically in its immediate post-independence years?	☐	☐	☐	
60	What was the 'Tripartite Declaration' issued by Britain,	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
	France, and the United States in May 1950?				

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): _____

Date: _____

KT 1.3: Increased Tension, Nasser, and the Suez Crisis, 1955–1963

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
61	What political revolution in July 1952 transformed Egypt from a pro-British monarchy into a radical nationalist republic?	☐	☐	☐	
62	What major geopolitical ideology did President Nasser champion, advocating the political, cultural, and economic unification of all Arab peoples?	☐	☐	☐	
63	What landmark September 1955 agreement shattered the Western arms monopoly in the Middle East and alarmed both Israel and the United States?	☐	☐	☐	
64	What decision by US Secretary of State John Foster Dulles in July 1956 directly triggered the Suez Crisis?	☐	☐	☐	
65	On what historic date did President Nasser nationalise the Suez Canal Company during a fiery speech in Alexandria?	☐	☐	☐	
66	Why was British Prime Minister Sir Anthony Eden so personally hostile toward Gamal Abdel Nasser?	☐	☐	☐	
67	Why was France eager to join a military operation against Nasser in 1956?	☐	☐	☐	
68	What secret collusion agreement was signed in October 1956 in a French villa between representatives of Britain, France, and Israel?	☐	☐	☐	
69	What was Operation Kadesh launched on 29 October 1956?	☐	☐	☐	
70	What did the joint Anglo-French ultimatum issued on 30 October 1956 demand of Egypt and Israel?	☐	☐	☐	
71	How did President Dwight D. Eisenhower and the United States respond to the Anglo-French military intervention at Suez?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
72	What threat did Soviet Premier Nikolai Bulganin make against Britain and France in November 1956 during the height of the crisis?	☐	☐	☐	
73	What innovative peacekeeping body was created by the UN General Assembly in November 1956 to oversee the withdrawal of invading forces from Egypt?	☐	☐	☐	
74	What was the ultimate geopolitical consequence of the 1956 Suez Crisis for Britain and France?	☐	☐	☐	
75	What major political victory did Gamal Abdel Nasser achieve despite Egypt suffering defeat on the battlefield in 1956?	☐	☐	☐	
76	What conditions did Israeli Prime Minister David Ben-Gurion secure before agreeing to withdraw the IDF from Sinai and Gaza in March 1957?	☐	☐	☐	
77	What was the 'Eisenhower Doctrine' announced by the US President in January 1957 following the Suez Crisis?	☐	☐	☐	
78	What political union was formed in February 1958, uniting Egypt and Syria under President Nasser's single leadership?	☐	☐	☐	
79	What dramatic event in July 1958 brought an abrupt end to the pro-Western Hashemite monarchy in Iraq?	☐	☐	☐	
80	What secret assistance did France begin providing to Israel in the late 1950s as a reward for their military cooperation at Suez?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): _____

Date: _____

THE VAULT

Restricted Access: Answer Keys

KT 1.0: Broken Promises & Imperial Borders: Why Was Conflict in the Middle East Inevitable?

1. The Suez Canal
2. The Straits of Tiran
3. The Sinai Peninsula
4. The River Jordan
5. Jerusalem
6. The Golan Heights
7. The Gaza Strip
8. The West Bank
9. The Green Line
10. The Negev Desert
11. Eilat
12. Sharm el-Sheikh
13. The Sea of Galilee (Lake Tiberias)
14. Southern Lebanon
15. The Bar-Lev Line
16. Beirut
17. Zionism
18. Arabs demanded an independent democratic state based on majority rule, while Jews demanded an independent sovereign state to absorb Holocaust survivors
19. Transjordan (Jordan)
20. Approximately 1.2 million Palestinian Arabs and 600,000 Jews



KT 1.1: The End of the British Mandate and the Creation of Israel, 1945–1949

21. Palestinian Arabs demanded immediate national independence and an end to immigration, while Zionists demanded a sovereign Jewish state and open entry for Holocaust survivors
22. The bombing of the King David Hotel in Jerusalem
23. The SS Exodus 1947
24. Partitioning Palestine into separate Arab and Jewish states with Jerusalem under international control
25. The Jewish Agency accepted partition, whereas the Arab Higher Committee rejected it completely
26. To secure vital transport corridors (especially Tel Aviv-Jerusalem) and clear hostile villages prior to British departure
27. The Deir Yassin massacre

KT 1.1: The End of the British Mandate and the Creation of Israel, 1945–1949

28. David Ben-Gurion
29. Armies from five neighboring Arab states invaded the newly declared State of Israel
30. It allowed Israel to reorganize the IDF, train conscripts, and import modern weapons from Czechoslovakia
31. Count Folke Bernadotte
32. The Green Line
33. Approximately 79%
34. The Arab Legion of Transjordan
35. The Irgun executed two kidnapped British intelligence sergeants in retaliation for British hangings of Irgun members
36. It was annexed by Jordan (West Bank) and placed under Egyptian military control (Gaza Strip)
37. To bypass Arab Legion blockades at Latrun and deliver vital food and weapons to besieged Jewish residents in Jerusalem
38. The Altalena Affair
39. The Soviet Union
40. On the island of Rhodes



KT 1.2: The Aftermath of the 1948–49 War & The Palestinian Refugee Crisis

41. The Nakba
42. Refugees wishing to return in peace should be permitted to do so, or be compensated for lost property
43. UNRWA (United Nations Relief and Works Agency)
44. The Law of Return
45. The Absentee Property Law
46. The secret airlift of approximately 50,000 Yemenite Jews to Israel
47. Many Israelis, led by Menachem Begin, viewed accepting German money as blood money for the Holocaust
48. Fedayeen
49. To deter future infiltration by launching disproportionately severe military counter-strikes against Arab border villages and bases
50. The Qibya Raid
51. Because he was suspected of conducting secret bilateral peace negotiations with Israel
52. It humiliated Nasser and directly prompted Egypt to conclude the Czech Arms Deal with the Soviet bloc
53. A period of strict economic austerity, price controls, and food rationing to absorb hundreds of thousands of penniless immigrants
54. Under a strict system of Military Administration with curfews, travel permits, and special courts

KT 1.2: The Aftermath of the 1948–49 War & The Palestinian Refugee Crisis

55. It shattered Egyptian military pride and directly convinced President Nasser to seek modern weapons from the Soviet bloc
56. Mizrahi and Sephardic Jews from Arab and North African countries
57. Jordan
58. The Baghdad Pact
59. By providing extensive grants, private bond sales, and a $100 million Export-Import Bank loan
60. A pledge to regulate arms sales to both Arab states and Israel to prevent an arms race and oppose border changes by force

KT 1.3: Increased Tension, Nasser, and the Suez Crisis, 1955–1963

61. The Free Officers Revolution led by Gamal Abdel Nasser and Muhammad Naguib
62. Pan-Arabism
63. The Czechoslovak Arms Deal
64. The abrupt withdrawal of US and British financing for the Aswan High Dam
65. 26 July 1956
66. Eden viewed Nasser as a dangerous fascist dictator ('Mussolini on the Nile') who threatened Britain's imperial oil lifeline
67. France accused Nasser of providing crucial military and financial support to the FLN rebels in Algeria
68. The secret Sèvres agreement
69. The Israeli military invasion of the Sinai Peninsula, advancing rapidly toward the Suez Canal
70. That both sides stop fighting and withdraw their forces 10 miles away from the Suez Canal
71. With fury, threatening to collapse the British economy by selling US sterling reserves unless troops withdrew
72. He issued veiled threats that London and Paris were vulnerable to Soviet rocket strikes
73. UNEF (United Nations Emergency Force)
74. It decisively demonstrated that Britain and France were no longer first-tier global superpowers and could not act independently of the US
75. He emerged as the heroic champion of the anti-imperialist Arab world, keeping control of the nationalised Suez Canal
76. Guarantees from the US and the deployment of UNEF troops ensuring freedom of navigation through the Straits of Tiran
77. A policy offering military and economic aid to any Middle Eastern nation threatened by armed aggression from Communist-controlled states
78. The United Arab Republic (UAR)
79. A bloody military coup led by Brigadier Abd al-Karim Qasim that murdered King Faisal II and Prime Minister Nuri al-Said
80. Construction of a secret nuclear reactor and reprocessing facility at Dimona in the Negev desert

Mastery Tracker

Track your total recall score across all 80 questions.

Attempt	Date	Score (/80)	Parent Validation Stamp	Target for Next Time
1			**PARENT VALIDATION STAMP** **Effort:** ⭐ ⭐ ⭐ (Circle 1–3) Date: _____ Signature: _____	
2			**PARENT VALIDATION STAMP** **Effort:** ⭐ ⭐ ⭐ (Circle 1–3) Date: _____ Signature: _____	
3			**PARENT VALIDATION STAMP** **Effort:** ⭐ ⭐ ⭐ (Circle 1–3) Date: _____ Signature: _____	

Operative Reflection

1. My ultimate strength in this unit is...

2. The three specific facts I need to hunt down and memorize tonight are...

3. Key targets and action steps for the next retrieval attempt: